

Mandarin tone sandhi

Task

Tone sandhi is a phonological phenomenon whereby realisation of lexical tone changes in specific tonal contexts. For instance, in Mandarin Chinese the third tone rule applies, which states that the third tone changes to the second tone when followed by another third tone. Another rule is the half-third tone rule stating that the third tone changes to low tone (half-third tone) when followed by any tone other than the third tone

Write a function `sandhi` which takes the two tones of a disyllabic word as arguments, each represented by a number from 1 to 5. The function should return a tuple of the two realized tones. Use the string "L" to represent the half-third tone.

Example

```
In [1]: import mandarin

In [2]: print(mandarin.sandhi(1, 4))
(1, 4)

In [3]: print(mandarin.sandhi(3, 3))
(2, 3)

In [4]: print(mandarin.sandhi(3, 1))
('L', 1)
```

```
In [5]: print(mandarin.sandhi(3, 5))  
('L', 5)
```

Reading

- PY4E chapters 3 and 4